

Google Cloud Certification Journey

Professional Cloud Architect

Cohort start date - June 23, 2026

Cohort ID: PCA03-GETCERT/2026.06.23

Trainer: Julien Moreau

Cohort Coordinator: Saumya Nautiyal

Program Lead: Alyssa Groves



Agenda

Market Trends



Why get Google Cloud certified?



Google Cloud Certifications



Google Cloud Certification Journey Overview



Additional Resources



Trends we are seeing in Training & Certifications



Increase in Certified IT Professionals

93% IT professionals (survey respondents) have at least 1 certification.



Skills Gap Issues Persist

67% (two-thirds) of decision-makers report skill gaps on their teams, with nearly 67% forecasting them in the next few years.



Invested Interest in Training

97% of IT decision-makers say certified staff add value to their organizations.



Why professionals train?

The number one reason to train - cited by both IT decision makers and IT staff is to build new skills.

Skilled Workforce is Key to Transforming your Business

Comprehensively training organizations are **80%** more likely to **achieve their business goals**

3x

More likely to achieve their innovation goals

3.8x

More likely to meet ROI objectives

4.4x

More likely to overcome operational concerns

1.9x

More likely to move beyond limited deployment

Professional Cloud Architect Certification Journey Program



Why get Certified?



GCP certification proves that an engineer not only has real-world experience, but also has the technical knowledge to operate at the level required.

Welby McRoberts

Customer Reliability Engineer for Managed GCP, Rackspace Ltd.

Google Cloud Certifications

Google Cloud Certifications Overview

Foundational

Cloud knowledge and working in the cloud

Associate

Recommended 6+ months hands-on experience with GCP

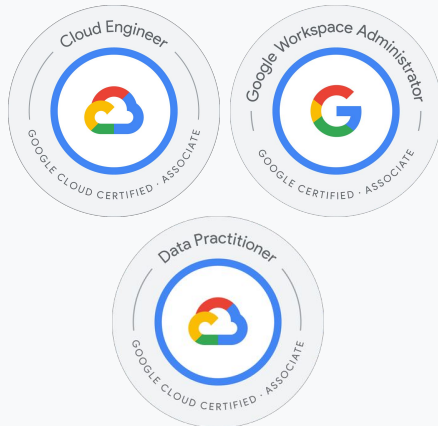
Professional

Recommended 3+ years industry experience & 1 year hands-on experience with GCP

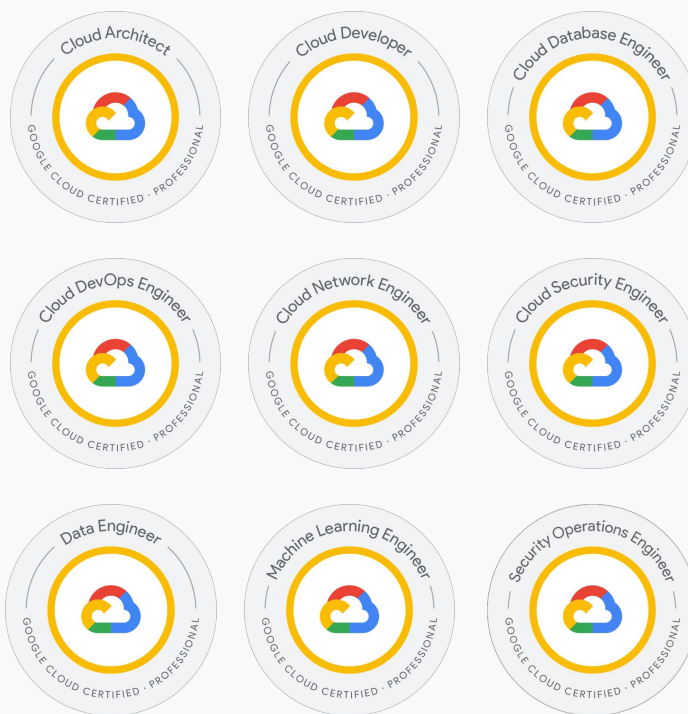
Foundational Level



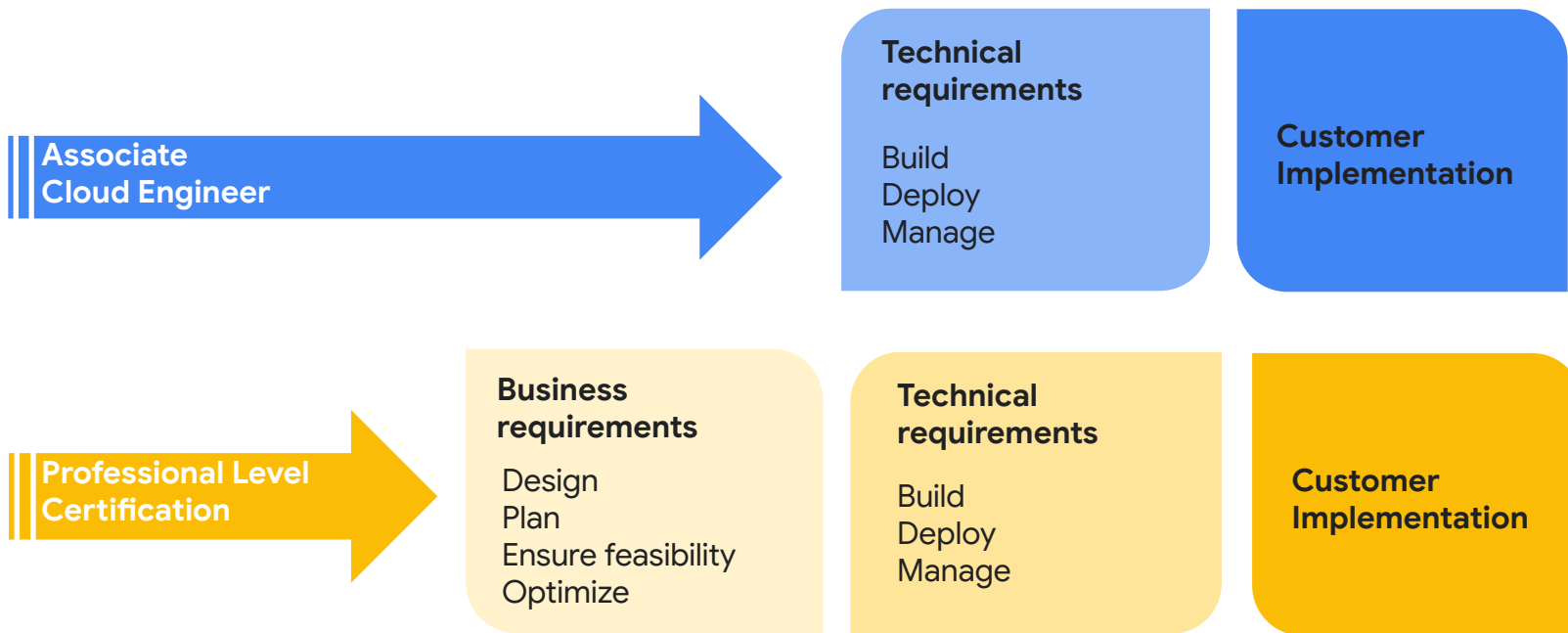
Associate Level



Professional Level



What is the difference between a **Associate** vs. **Professional** certification?



Professional Cloud Architect Certification

Recommended Experience - 3+ years of industry experience plus 1+ years designing and managing solutions using GCP



Role Responsibilities:

Design, develop, and manage robust, secure, scalable, highly available, and dynamic solutions to drive business objectives.



Exam Coverage

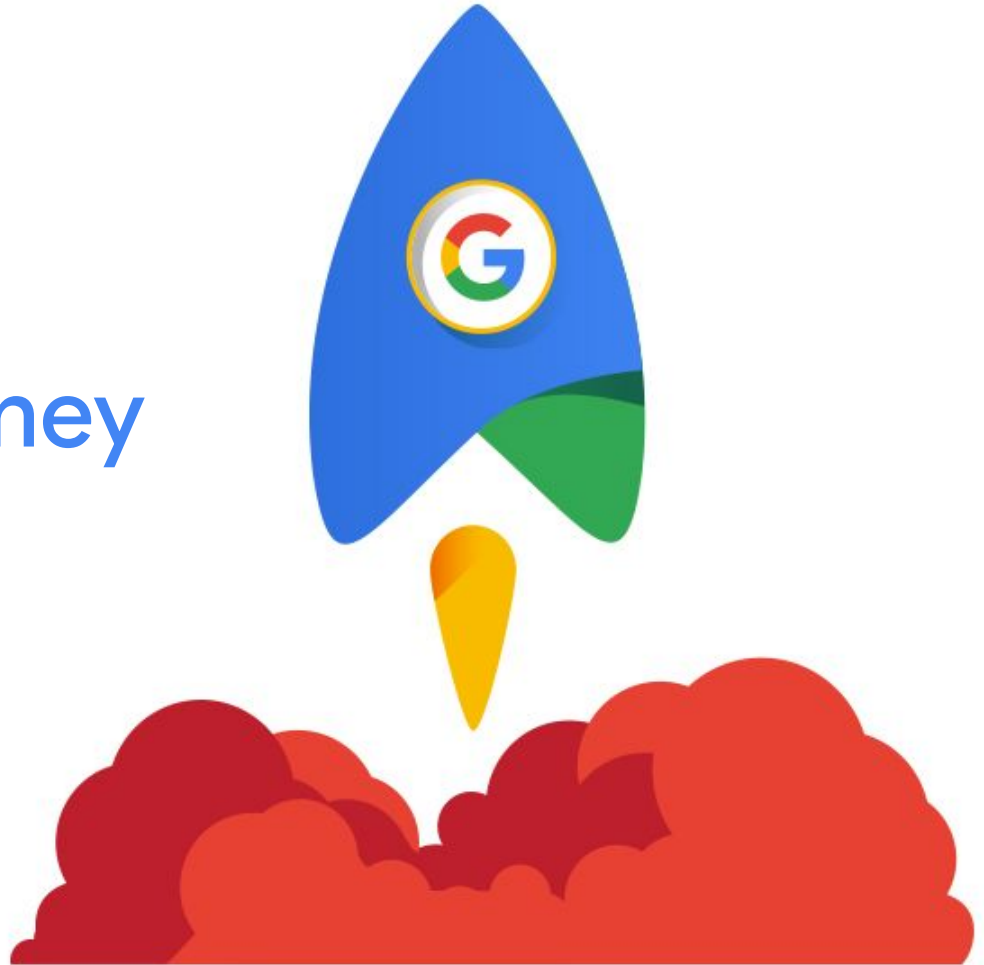
- Design and plan a cloud solution architecture
- Manage and provision the cloud solution architecture
- Design for security and compliance
- Analyze and optimize technical and business processes
- Manage implementations of cloud architecture
- Ensure solutions and operations liability

Google Skills

1. A hands-on lab is an online learning environment along with a set of instructions to walk you through a live, real world, and scenario-based use case. In a lab you have access to the actual environment you want to learn about, not a simulation or demo environment. You can access the lab environment from anywhere on the Internet using a standard browser.
2. You have a 6 months Google Skills credits with access to all Google Cloud labs, quests and Skill Badges. **Read carefully the email “Please create and activate your Google Skills account :-)” sent on June 23rd, 2026.** It has all the information you need to activate the account properly.

1. Google Skills support can be reached via:
 - a. Email: support-skills@google.com
 - b. [Google Skills Portal](#)
2. While contacting the support please provide the following:
 - a. Your login email address
 - b. Description of an issue to be solved
 - c. Screenshots of the issue (if needed)

Google Cloud Certification Journey Overview



Certification Journey Learning Program

A **guided 6 week-job program** which prepares technical practitioners for in-demand/ILT **Google Cloud certifications. Certifications** validate technical expertise and take organizations as well as the careers to the next level.



Professional Cloud Architect

Dates overview

Weeks

1-3

Time zone:
CEST

Pre-work

To be done
before:

June 23, 2026

Week 1

Start

June 22, 2026

Duration

~ 9 h

Week 2

Start

June 29, 2026

Duration

~ 15 h

Week 3

Start

July 06, 2026

Duration

~ 17 h

Exam guide reviews sessions

Date

June 23, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Date

June 30, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Date

July 07, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Online community support: The main communication channel of this program.

Connect with technical advisor to clarify remaining areas.

Peer to peer discussions and questions will be monitored during working days. Posting available from week 3.

End **Aug 26, 2026**Following
weeks on
the next
page

Professional Cloud Architect

Dates overview

Weeks

4-6

Time zone:
CEST

Week 4

Start

July 13, 2026

Duration

~ 12 h

Week 5

Start

July 20, 2026

Duration

~ 12 h

Week 6

Start

July 27, 2026

Duration

~ 14 h

Exams



Exam guide reviews sessions

Date

July 14, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Date

July 21, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Date

July 28, 2026

Time

11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Session recorded*

Online community support: The main communication channel of this program.

Connect with technical advisor to clarify remaining areas.

Peer to peer discussions and questions will be monitored during working days. Posting available from week 3.

End **Aug 26, 2026**Learning plan
continuation

Professional Cloud Architect

Learning plan

Weeks

1-3



★ Skill badge

Pre-work

Review:

[Professional Cloud Architect Certification Exam Guide](#)

[Professional Cloud Architect Sample Questions](#)

Week 1

Please complete:

[Google Cloud Fundamentals: Core Infrastructure](#)

[Essential Google Cloud Infrastructure: Core Services](#)

★ [Implement Load Balancing on Compute Engine](#)

Required*

Week 2

Please complete:

[Networking in Google Cloud: Fundamentals](#)

[Elastic Google Cloud Infrastructure: Scaling and Automation](#)

★ [Set Up an App Dev Environment on Google Cloud](#)

Required*

Week 3

Please complete:

[Networking in Google Cloud: Network Architecture](#)

[Managing Security in Google Cloud](#)

★ [Implement Cloud Security Fundamentals on Google Cloud](#)

Required*

Exam Voucher: You can apply for an exam voucher starting from **week 4**, after meeting the below criteria:

*Complete at least **5** (out of 7) Google Cloud skill badges and one mandatory course from your learning plan, share your public GS profile with us by filling in this **form** and **get your exam voucher!** Voucher is awarded based on skill badges completion and the availability.

The voucher form is open until **August 26, 2026**.

Last day to attempt the Exam: **September 17, 2026**.

Following weeks on the next page

Professional Cloud Architect

Learning plan

Weeks

4-6

★ Skill badge



Exams



Week 4

Please complete:

[Getting Started with Terraform for Google Cloud](#)

[Reliable Google Cloud Infrastructure: Design and Process](#)

★ [Cloud Architecture: Design, Implement, and Manage](#)
Required*

Week 5

Please complete:

[Manage Scalable Workloads in GKE](#)

★ [Manage Kubernetes in Google Cloud](#)
Required*

★ [Engineer AI Agents with Agent Development Kit \(ADK\)](#)
Mandatory*
(This skill badge can't be skipped)

Week 6

Please complete:

[Observability in Google Cloud](#)

[Introduction to AI and Machine Learning on Google Cloud](#)

★ [Develop Serverless Applications on Cloud Run](#)
Required*

→ **Get your voucher if you have already completed 5 skill badges!**

Build exam readiness. Revise materials and session recordings.
Book the exam!*

Exam Voucher: You can apply for an exam voucher starting from **week 4**, after meeting the below criteria:

*Complete at least **5** (out of 7) Google Cloud skill badges and one mandatory course from your learning plan, share your public GS profile with us by filling in this **form** and **get your exam voucher!** Voucher is awarded based on skill badges completion and the availability.

The voucher form is open until **August 26, 2026**.

Last day to attempt the Exam: **September 17, 2026**.

Learning plan
continuation

Program elements



6 weeks guided learning program

Starting on **23rd June, 2026** at **11:00 AM - 12:30 PM CEST**



Technical mentorship provided by a **dedicated trainer** in a format of:

- **6 Exam guide review sessions** (online live sessions with a technical mentor. Sessions have a predefined content and structure)
- **Technical support** via **Online Community** until August 26, 2026.



A dedicated cohort coordinator **Saumya Nautiyal**

saumyanautiyal@xwf.google.com

Available Monday through Friday during business hours.



Exam voucher information

Get your exam voucher by filling this [form](#). Please allow **24-72** working hours to receive the voucher (from the request date). Please attempt the exam by **17th September, 2026**.

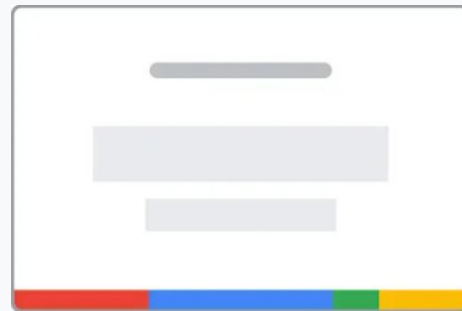


Learning platforms

Google Skills with access to the on-demand courses and hands-on labs.

Earn skill badges along the way

A [Google Skill badges](#) is a digital badge issued by Google Cloud in recognition of an individual's cloud proficiency with Google Cloud products and services and tests their ability to apply that knowledge in an interactive hands-on environment



[Watch this video](#) and learn what are the Google Skill Badges.
[This article](#) describes the value of the Google Skill Badges.

Get Certified and Grab Your Gear!

This year, we have an extra incentive - SWAG! Take and pass your certification exam by September 17, 2026 to qualify. Everyone who achieves certification by this date will receive a \$50 USD voucher to the [Google Cloud Perks Portal](#).



Disclaimer: Government employees are ineligible for this promotion.

Once you've finished the exam, you're all set! We'll track the voucher used and email the swag voucher to those who passed by **September 30**.

Program Resources
Training Platforms
Communication Channels
And... other available resources :-)

Communication Channels



Weekly Emails

Receive useful information on the status of your learning and tips & tricks to get the most out of your prescribed learning journey.



Exam Guide Review Sessions

Weekly exam guide review sessions with a dedicated trainer, who will answer questions and provide additional advice and preparation resources. 6 Exam Guide Review sessions, all sessions will be recorded and available for your cohort only.



Community Forum

For peer to peer support and a direct communication channel with your trainer.



Program Drive

Program assets, including the recordings from the exam guide review sessions will be stored here. Please make sure you can access this place.

[Action Required]: Fill out this [form](#) to gain access to the Google Group and Google Drive folder.

Program shortcuts

Proprietary + Confidential

Program asset	Access via	Content	Link
Online Community via Google Groups	Google Account	• Weekly updates according to learning plans • Trainer's support on technical questions • Cohort coordinator's support for program questions • Additional information about program-related events, news, features etc.	 
Program Folder via Google Drive	Google Account	• Learning plan • Session's decks • Recordings • Other materials	 
On demand training and Hands-on practice via Google Skills	Email address	• Google Skills is an online learning environment along with a set of instructions to walk you through a live, real world, and scenario-based use case. In a lab you have access to the actual environment you want to learn about, not a simulation or demo environment.	 
Google Form	Google Account	• To grant the access to Google Groups and Google Drive.	 

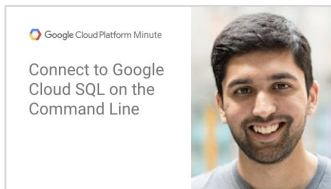
Additional resources

- Exam outlines and sample questions
- Product [documentation](#)
- Online practice labs and quests
- [“Free” Google Cloud accounts \(\\$300 credit\)](#)
- [Google Cloud Tech Youtube Channel](#)
- [Google Cloud Blog](#)
- [GCP sketchnote](#)
- [The Cloud Girl](#)
- [You can also purchase the PCA exam preparation book/ebook](#)



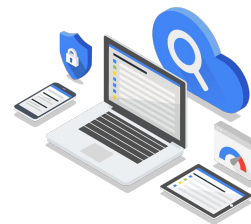
Google Cloud Tutorials

Find [step-by-step instructions](#) for completing common tasks like automated network deployment, disaster recovery planning, and more.



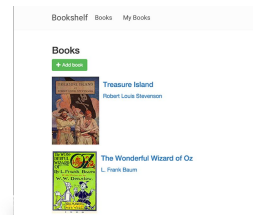
Cloud Minute

Watch one-minute how-to [videos](#) for dozens of simple tasks, like adding APIs to a Cloud Platform project or creating a bucket in GCS.



Google Cloud Quickstarts

Get started with Cloud Platform products, services, and APIs with these short [tutorials](#) – which range from beginner to advanced topics.



Sample Projects

Dive right into coding with [examples](#) that demonstrate how to use popular and powerful Google Cloud Platform products and features.

Program best practices

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Commit to completing the entire program, organize with your company projects accordingly.

Enjoy sessions with your trainer! Take notes, ask questions, be present and active.

Give yourself time to review exam recommended topics and take advantage of exam guide deep dives and live Q&A during the sessions with the trainer.

Register to take the exam as soon as possible :-)

Take advantage of the online community - reach out to your trainer, ask questions, brainstorm ideas, and support your peers.

Check your exam readiness by reviewing the Professional Cloud Architect [Exam Study Guide](#) and [sample questions](#)

Become a Certified Professional Cloud Architect!



Questions? :-)

Let's get started!





Contact info

If you have any questions, feel free to contact:

- pca03-getcert_q2_2026@googlegroups.com
- saumyanautiyal@xwf.google.com

Google Cloud

